

PowerDB FAQ

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User Accounts Permissions

	Administrator	Manager	Power User	User	Technician	Form Designer
Form Tree						
Create New	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES
Edit	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES
Delete	If not assoc. with asset	NO	NO	NO	NO	If not assoc. with asset
Retire / Reinstate	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO
Move	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES
Merge	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES
Preview Mode	N/A	YES	YES	YES	YES	N/A

SubForm Tree						
Create New	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES
Edit	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES
Delete	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES

Job List						
Create New Job	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO
Edit Job Properties	If not completed	If not completed	If not completed	only if creator	only if creator	NO
Delete Job	YES	Yes - F1	Yes - F1	NO	NO	NO
"Complete" a job	YES	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO
Un-complete Job	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO
Print a job report	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO	NO
Be designated as job manager	YES	YES	YES	NO	NO	NO

Job Tree							
Add Asset / Enter new data	YES - E1	YES - E1	YES - E1	YES - E1	YES - E1	YES - E1	NO
Edit existing data	YES - E1	YES - E1	YES - E1	Only if originator - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	NO
Delete Test Data	YES - E1 E2	YES - E1 E2	YES - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	NO
Remove Asset from job	YES - E1 E2	YES - E1 E2	YES - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	Only if originator - E1 E2	NO
View Completed	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO

Exceptions and Future release notes:	
E1	Cannot if it is a completed job
E2	Can be changed in Database Admin settings

	Administrator	Manager	Power User	User	Technician	Form Designer
Address Book						
Create New	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO
Edit existing	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO
Delete address	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO
Delete Company	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	NO

Configuration							
Alter system settings	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO
Alter region names	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO

User Accounts						
Create new	YES	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO
Edit accounts	YES	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO
Delete	YES	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO
Change user password	YES	YES	Own Only	Own Only	Own Only	Own Only

How do I print the Job results?	
1.	Select the JOB tab and View Job List in the Navigation panel until you are viewing the Job listing.
2.	Right-click to select the Job to print from the Job list.
3.	From the right-click menu, select Print Job Results. Alternately you may select Print from the File panel or from the Quick Access Toolbar. You may also select Save To PDF from the File panel.
4.	If you have any asset that has been added to the job but does not have data associated with it a dialog will be displayed to prompt if you want to print blank forms. Select Yes if you want to print blank forms. Note: for Jobs printed with blank results the Table of Contents and test results will not generate job numbers.
5.	The Print Results dialog will now be displayed. To set up your desired print sort order, press the Edit Sort button. To use one or more attributes, select the attribute(s) listed in the left and press the Add button. To remove sort attributes, select the attribute in the right list and press the Remove button. You may adjust the order of priority of selected attributes by selecting an attribute and pressing the Up and Down buttons.
6.	If you wish to print the Table of Contents, Comments Summary and Deficiency Summary select each check box to add those sections to the report.
7.	Select Include External Docs to print any attached external documents in the job. NOTE: These will print out at the end of all other report pieces.
8.	Press the Save & Print button to print, Save & Close, or Cancel. If you selected Save To PDF in step 3 you may press the Save To PDF button, Save & Close, or Cancel.

How do I print an individual test form from a Job?	
1.	Select the desired Job from the Job List and double-click to open the Job. Select the test form from the tree and open the form. Click on the form to enable the Print function.
2.	Press the Print toolbar button. Press OK to print or press Cancel.

How do I print a group of test forms from a Job?	
1.	Select the JOB tab and View Job List in the Navigation panel until you are viewing the Job listing.
2.	Select the Job from the Job List.
3.	From the right-click menu, select Print Job Results. Alternately you may select Print from the Quick Access Toolbar.
4.	You may sort the test forms to group together the desired results. Select the Print Selection radio button under the Data Range options. Enter the first and last number of the results to be printed from the # column.
5.	Press OK to print or press Cancel.

How do I spell check a test form?	
1.	To spell check the entire test form, deselect all controls by clicking in a blank portion of the form. Note: the spell check feature is only available in the Job portion of PowerDB.
2.	Select the Tools tab and then select Check Spelling in the Forms panel.
3.	To spell check a single input field, click in the field, then select Check Spelling in the Forms panel.

How do I move a softkey license?	
1.	Select the Tools tab, and then select PDB Licensing in the Licensing panel. Note: If either machine does not have connection to the internet, follow the instructions provided in the Licensing dialog box, Manual License selection.
2.	In the Licensing dialog box, make note of the serial number displayed at the top. Select the Release button and wait for confirmation that the license was released.
3.	Type 'remove' in the edit box of the Remove PowerDB License dialog box and press OK.
4.	Start PowerDB on the new machine. Select the Tools tab, and then select PDB Licensing in the Licensing panel.
5.	Press Activate License and enter the serial number and registration information. Press the Activate button and wait for confirmation that licensing was successful. Log in again.

How do I change the active database?	
1.	Select the Database tab and select Change Database in the General panel.
2.	Browse to the directory that contains the desired database.
3.	Double-click on the database file. It should now appear as the active database in the dialog box. Press OK. The program will prompt you that it will shut down, press OK. PowerDB restarts on its own after changing databases.
4.	The active database filename is displayed in the status bar located at the bottom of the window.

How do I create a new User Account?	
1.	Select the User Accounts tab to display the current user accounts. The Administrator account is a built-in account and may not be removed. It is strongly suggested that this account be password protected. Note: Refer to the User's Manual for details on privilege levels.
2.	Select New User in the File panel.
3.	Complete the fields in the dialog box. Press OK.

How do I edit an existing User Account?	
1.	Select the User Accounts tab to display the current user accounts. The Administrator account is a built-in account and may not be removed. Note: Refer to the User's Manual for details on privilege levels.
2.	Select the user account to be edited from the list and select Properties in the Options panel.
3.	Make the appropriate changes. Press OK.

How do I add new company records to my address book? (Testing Co. style)	
1.	Select the Tools tab then select Address Book in the Accounts panel.
2.	Press on the Add New Company button, enter the company name and press OK.
3.	Press the New Address button then select the type of address (customer, owner, plant) in the Type dropdown box. A Customer is who is paying for the work to be done. The Customer name and address information as entered here will be used in the header of related test forms. An Owner is who owns the asset being tested. The Owner name and address as entered here will be used in the header of related test forms. A Plant is the physical location of the asset to be tested. The Owner and Plant information automatically populate in the Job navigation tree.
4.	Fill in the address information fields and press the Save button.
5.	Repeat steps 3-5 for all addresses related to this company. The drop-down box described as Type determines whether the address entered is stored as a Customer, Owner or Plant. The drop-down box described as Show Types determines which addresses by type are displayed for editing.

How do I set up a new Job?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	While viewing the Job list, select New Job in the File panel.
3.	Select the company and address information under each tab of the Job Properties dialog box. Set the Job Number and complete other information under the General and Details tabs if desired.
4.	Press OK. The new Job will appear in the Job List. Double-click on the row to open the Job.

How do I set up a new Job for a new customer?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	While viewing the Job list, select New Job in the File panel.
3.	Press the Edit Selection button. Press on the Address Book button.
4.	Press on the Add New Company button and enter the name. Press on the New Address button to enter an address.
5.	Select the type of address and complete the new address information. Customer and Owner addresses should be added.
6.	Press the Save button for each address added. Enter all types of addresses for the same company into the same record.
7.	Press the Close button.
8.	Select the company in the upper half of the window and the appropriate address in the lower portion, matching the properties tab displayed.
9.	Complete the Job Number, General and Details tab as desired.
10.	Press the OK button to exit Job Properties. The new Job will appear in the Job List. Double-click on the row to open the Job.

How do I add assets/forms to a Job?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	Double-click on the job in the Job List. The job information will appear in the navigation tree.
3.	Right click on the Job tree and choose Add to Job, or select Add to Job in the File panel.
4.	Select from the information displayed or enter new information in the edit box. Press the Next button.
5.	Repeat step 4 for each Org Level until the form selection dialog appears.
6.	Select the desired view for the forms list: Normal (Grouped by Family/Type) Show All Show All for Instrument Group by Type Only
7.	Make selections in the dialog listing and press Next until a list of forms is displayed.
8.	Select a form to add to the job. You may select multiple forms by holding down the Ctrl key. Press the Finish button. The selected forms will then appear in the navigation tree.

How do I insert different folders for the same Job?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	Double-click on the job in the Job List. The job information will appear in the navigation tree.
3.	Click on a folder at a level above the level you wish to add, for example to add a new Substation folder click on a Plant level folder.
4.	Right click on the selected folder level and choose Add to Job, or select Add to Job in the File panel.
5.	You may select existing information in the upper portion of the dialog box or add new information in the edit box in the lower portion of the dialog box. Press the Next button.
6.	Proceed through the Enter or Select dialog boxes by entering information and pressing the Next button, or press the Back button to return to higher level folders.
7.	Add the test sheet(s) required at this tree folder and click the Finish button. View your changes in the navigation tree for correctness.
8.	NOTE: Test forms may be added at any level in the Job tree by selecting <Insert Test Form At This Level> in the dialog box and then pressing the Next button. Lower Job tree levels will be skipped and the form selection dialog will appear.

How do I move assets/results within a Job?	
1.	You may move assets within the Job Tree by two different methods.
2.	Method 1 – To move all assets and results in a folder right-click on the folder and select Rename. The change can be applied to all results by responding Yes to the update prompt.
3.	Method 2 – Open a set of results and edit the appropriate Header fields in the test form. The navigation tree will be updated by responding Yes to the prompt.

How do I move assets/results to another Job?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	Double-click on the job in the Job list. The job information will appear in the navigation tree.
3.	While viewing the navigation tree for the first job, click on the asset you want to move. Right-click and choose Move To Job. The system will prompt you that the asset will be associated with another job. Press OK to continue.
4.	Select the new job from the list and press OK.

How do I move assets/results to another location?	
1.	Select the Asset tab. If the Asset tree is not displayed select View Asset Tree.
2.	Locate the asset(s) that you want to move. This can be done to individual assets or folders higher in the Asset tree.
3.	Right click on the asset/branch that you want to move. Select Move Assets.
4.	Follow the prompts and select the location that you want as the destination.
5.	Verify that the chosen assets are now at the correct location.

How do I set up a Job for repeat testing?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	If you are going to repeat the same test forms for the same assets, select the job in the Job list, then choose Copy/Paste Job from the right-click menu. The assets from the old job will be associated with the new job. Historical data for each asset can be viewed from the new job, but only new data added to the new job can be modified.
3.	The new job will be added to the Job List with the next available Job Number. You can edit the Job Number under the General tab in the Job Properties dialog box.

How do I pre-populate nameplate data from another form?	
1.	Select the Job tab. If the Job list is not displayed select View Job List.
2.	Double click on the job in the Job List. The job information will appear in the navigation tree.
3.	Open a test form where the desired nameplate information has been saved.
4.	While in the same job, open a new test form or add a new test form from the same form family. The system will prompt you if you want to use the same nameplate information from the previous test.

What is the difference between the Asset and Job view?	
The Asset view is an inventory listing of each asset in the database while the Job view contains only the assets for the selected job.	
1.	Click on the Asset toolbar button to view the Asset list. Press View Asset Tree. The tree is an inventory of each asset in the database. Assets can be added to the database only by opening a Job and adding assets to the Job. Assets can be deleted from the database in the Asset tree by choosing Delete from the right-click menu. Test results can be viewed from the Asset navigation tree but cannot be changed.
2.	The Asset List is a tabular listing of all assets in the database. The list can be sorted and filtered using the column headings and the filter bar.
3.	Click on the Job toolbar button to view the Job List and to view a selected Job tree. In the Job view you can add, move, remove, copy, paste or delete assets or test data from the right-click menu. Test data may be entered, changed, Spell Checked and saved to the database in an active Job test form.

How do I send a new technician into the field?	
1.	It is suggested to create the new technician's user account in the master database before creating the field database. Go to User Accounts and create the user account. Click the Job tab and View Job List. Confirm the appropriate region is selected in the toolbar.
2.	Click the File menu, select New Database and then select New Field DB. In the Database Utilities menu confirm the source DB is the Master database. Under the Advanced Options button you may select to include the full address book for the region (suggested for database creation purposes). Click the Create DB button. In the Open dialog create the field database file name and set where the file will be saved, click the Open button.
3.	You will be prompted for a user name to log in to the master (source) database. Click OK. The PowerDB Synchronization Status window will be visible and will indicate when the process is complete. Click the Finish button. At this point the new field database has configuration settings and user accounts migrated but does not have job records, assets or results migrated.
4.	From the Tools tab select Synchronize Region. In the Database Utilities dialog confirm the Primary Database is the master and the Secondary database is the new field database. Select Publish Region in the Operation dropdown. Click the Publish Region button.
5.	After the process is completed, wait five minutes and repeat step 4 between the same two databases.
6.	At this point the published field database has not been open by the application and a unique database ID has not been associated with the file. This field database .mdb file may be copied and distributed to multiple end users.

How do I get data from the field or a USB drive?	
1.	Click the Jobs toolbar button. Confirm the appropriate region is selected in the toolbar.
2.	Click the Tools toolbar button and select Synchronize Region or choose Synchronize Region from the right click menu of the Job List. This will open the PowerDB Database Utility dialog. Note: either the master or the field database may initiate the synchronization.
3.	Select the primary (master or USB drive) and the secondary database for the data transfer. If the primary database is on a remote computer you may access the database by entering the IP address of the remote machine. There is an option to backup each of the databases prior to the synchronization.
4.	Select Transfer Data in the Operation dropdown box and the Region Synch radio button. Click the Start Transfer button.

How do I create a backup of my database?	
1.	Click the File button on the toolbar and select Change Database to determine the path of your database file.
2.	Use Windows Explorer to locate your database file. Right click and choose Copy. Paste your file in a different location or on an external device.

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2.	Use Windows Explorer to locate your database file. Right click and choose Copy. Paste your file in a different location or on an external device.

How do I pre-populate default Comments and Deficiencies?	
1.	In the SubForm Tree of a Development database, open the User Data subform. Place your cursor in the lower right portion of the small red box and double click. This will open Form Properties. Click the Script button and select the Data tab.
2.	In the areas indicated enter your default Comments and Deficiencies exactly as you wish them to appear. (i.e., enter comments between "DefaultComments:" and ":END", and enter deficiencies between "DefaultDeficiencies:" and ":END")
3.	Click OK, return to the Form Properties dialog box and click OK. Save your changes.

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